RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

17 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 1:49 PM, Saturday 17 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 25 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 22 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 8,190 minutes at 2:00 PM; Dammam moving, latest takeoff Air Arabia 4P3 to Jeddah at 1:33 PM

1

INCIDENT SUMMARY

What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 8,190 minutes at 2:00 PM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct, and GACA has not announced a reopening**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 25 flights cancelled so far for Saturday (20% of scheduled).
- Riyadh airport's official account tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates, with no reopening time given.
- No new attack, interception or attack alert from official channels since the 10:52 AM Interior Ministry warning; Civil Defense's 1:00 PM posts were weather warnings.
- Dammam moving with no halt open: 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour, latest Air Arabia 4P3 to Jeddah at 1:33 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8180 min).

25
CANCELLED TODAY

0/0
TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H

0
DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

22
CANCELLED TODAY

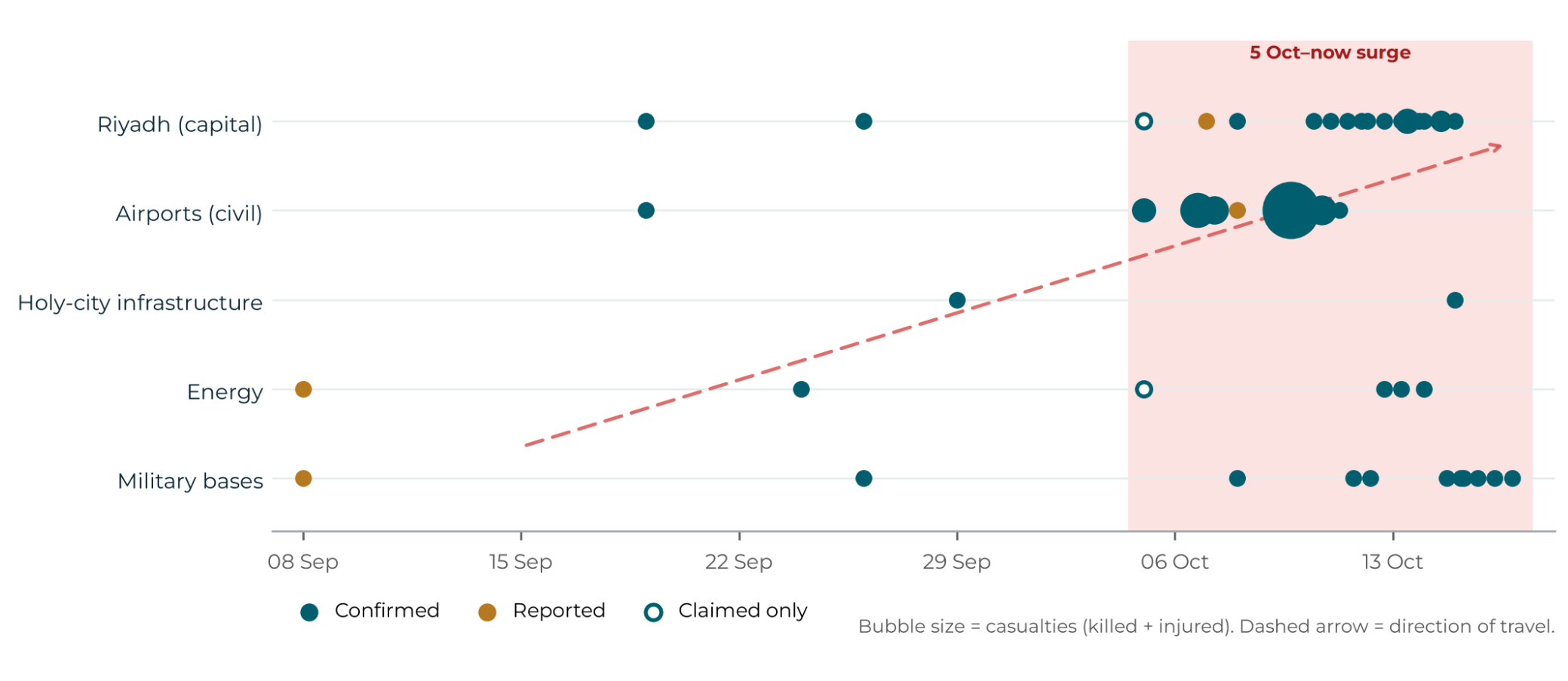
1/1
TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H

0
DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (8,190 min at 2:00 PM)
- Riyadh airport's account tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates (1:10 to 1:27 PM); no reopening time given
- Dammam moving with no halt open: 1 takeoff (4P3) and 1 landing (SV1114) in the last hour

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 17 OCT



45 sourced events since 8 September (39 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: three UAVs intercepted and destroyed in the southern and Riyadh regions (16 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

2

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 1:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 1:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 4, alerts 4, all-clears 4.

3

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, 10 hours before the NOTAM's planned reopening; airport still gives no reopening time

Checked at 1:56 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities and their airline for airspace updates; still no reopening announcement**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **1:27 PM** · replies to passengers published 1:10, 1:16, 1:20 and 1:27 PM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 1:56 PM

In a series of replies to passengers between 1:10 and 1:27 PM, King Khalid International Airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the competent official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. The airport gave no reopening time; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct.

CORROBORATED **Air India and Air India Express extend their suspension of Riyadh, Dammam and Jeddah flights to 24 October**

Sidhant Sibal (@sidhant), WION diplomatic correspondent · **12:50 PM** · posted 12:50 PM AST Sat 17 Oct; AeroCorner (8:25 AM AST) separately reports Air India, IndiGo and Akasa cancelling Saudi flights past the NOTAM; no Air India statement seen yet; checked 12:58 PM

Journalist Sidhant Sibal reports that Air India and Air India Express have extended their suspension of flights to and from Jeddah, Riyadh and Dammam until 24 October. AeroCorner separately reports Indian carriers cancelling Saudi flights past the closure notice. This replaces an earlier single-account report of a 20 October date.

CONFIRMED **Finance Minister Al-Jadaan says Saudi investments have limited the fallout from the global energy shock**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:24 AM** · published 11:24 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, translated from Arabic); remarks at a press conference in Bangkok; checked 11:52 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reports that Finance Minister Mohammed Al-Jadaan told a press conference in Bangkok that the Kingdom's investments have limited the impact of the global energy shock. The post did not give figures.

CONFIRMED **Arab Tourism Organization condemns the Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and declares full solidarity**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **11:02 AM** · published 11:02 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, translated from Arabic); checked 11:52 AM

Al Ekhbariya reports that the Arab Tourism Organization condemned the Houthi militia's attacks on Saudi Arabia, affirmed its full solidarity with the Kingdom, and called for the attacks to stop and for those responsible to be held to account.

CONFIRMED **Interior Ministry warns that filming or sharing intercepts and impact sites of missiles and drones brings legal liability**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD), relaying the Interior Ministry · **10:52 AM** · published 10:52 AM AST Sat 17 Oct, right after the Abha and Khamis Mushait all-clears; checked 11:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense, citing the Interior Ministry, warned that filming, publishing or sharing information about the interception of missiles and drones or where they fall exposes people to legal accountability.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense issues early-warning alerts for Abha and Khamis Mushait, then all-clears four minutes later**

Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **10:47 AM** · alerts posted 10:46 AM (Khamis Mushait) and 10:47 AM (Abha) AST Sat 17 Oct; all-clears for both at 10:51 AM; relayed by Al Ekhbariya at 10:49 AM; checked 10:54 AM; a social account (@arrowred48, 11:07 AM) said the alerts were for a Houthi missile attack on Abha and bases in Khamis Mushait, which no official channel has confirmed; rechecked 11:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense says the National Early Warning Platform issued alerts in Khamis Mushait Governorate at 10:46 AM and Abha City at 10:47 AM to warn of a potential danger. At 10:51 AM it posted that the danger had passed in both and told residents to keep following its instructions and avoid gathering or filming. It did not say what the danger was, and no intercept or attack statement had been posted by 11:52 AM. A social account claimed a Houthi missile attack on Abha and Khamis Mushait; this is unverified.

UNVERIFIED **WSJ: Iran helped the Houthis target drone and missile attacks on Saudi Arabia, people briefed on Saudi intelligence say**

Iran International (@IranIntl_En), citing The Wall Street Journal · **9:38 AM** · posted 9:38 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; WSJ article not read directly; Iran has denied Saudi accusations of involvement; several outlets carried Iran's denial by 11:19 AM; checked 11:52 AM

Iran International, citing The Wall Street Journal, reports that Iran has helped the Houthis target drone and missile attacks and has given training, intelligence and tactical guidance for attacks on Saudi Arabia and its Yemeni allies, according to people briefed on Saudi intelligence. Tehran has publicly rejected Saudi claims that it encouraged the attacks.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense urges caution as thunderstorms continue; new weather warnings for Makkah, Asir, Jazan and Al-Baha at 12:58 to 1:00 PM**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:00 PM** · first published 8:45 AM AST Sat 17 Oct by Al Ekhbariya; Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) posted regional weather warnings at 12:58, 12:59 and 1:00 PM (official, translated from Arabic); weather alerts, not attack alerts; checked 1:56 PM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reports that the General Directorate of Civil Defense is calling on residents to take care as thunderstorms continue over most regions of the Kingdom until next Wednesday. At 9:36 AM the channel aired footage of rain falling on Arar in the Northern Borders region. At 12:58 to 1:00 PM the Civil Defense account issued fresh weather warnings for parts of the Makkah, Asir, Jazan and Al-Baha regions.

UNVERIFIED DMM **Social accounts report explosions heard around Dammam and fires at Eastern Province oil facilities overnight**

X (@TomthunkitsMind, @AlhryaWaltaghyr, @osinthexagone) · **7:33 AM** · Posted 6:43-7:33 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; no Civil Defense alert for Dammam, SPA, Ministry of Defense or Aramco statement found; checked 7:58 AM; at 11:37 AM @TPObserver posted images it said show smoke rising from oil facilities in the Khurais area, also unverified

Several social accounts, some Houthi-aligned, say explosions were heard around Dammam overnight and that fires are burning at oil facilities in the Eastern Province; one OSINT account shared unverified footage of a possible ballistic missile impact at an unknown Eastern Province location and said the situation at King Fahd International Airport appears to be over. No official Saudi channel has confirmed an attack, intercept or impact. Dammam airport resumed movements at 7:17 AM.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Weather service forecasts moderate to heavy thunderstorms in the southwest and fog on the Eastern Province coast**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 7:58 AM

The National Center for Meteorology forecasts moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash flooding, hail and strong winds over Jazan, Asir, Al Baha and Makkah, with fog forming, including over coastal parts of Madinah and the Eastern Province.

CONFIRMED **UK Foreign Office now advises against all but essential travel to Saudi Arabia**

UK FCDO (gov.uk) · **16 Oct** · gov.uk travel advice updated 16 Oct, still current 17 Oct; first relayed on X 5:40 AM; checked 8:58 AM

The FCDO's Saudi Arabia page now advises against all but essential travel to the whole country and all travel within 10 km of the Yemen border. It tells British nationals to stay away from King Khalid International Airport until it is secure and says further attacks on airports are very likely; it suggests leaving by land to a neighbouring country as an alternative to Saudi airports.

UNVERIFIED **EU-GCC summit planned in Riyadh reported postponed amid Houthi strikes**

5W1H Brief (@5w1hbrief) · **6:16 AM** · posted 6:16 AM AST Sat 17 Oct, citing unnamed reports; no official GCC or EU statement checked; checked 6:20 AM

A news-summary account reported that the EU-Gulf Cooperation Council summit planned in Riyadh has been postponed, with a new date to be announced later. No official GCC or European Council statement has been seen yet.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Yemen's Transport Ministry condemns the Houthi militia's second attack on Aden International Airport**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:50 AM** · published 5:50 AM AST Sat 17 Oct (official Saudi channel, Arabic, translated); checked 6:20 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's Ministry of Transport condemned the Houthi militia for targeting Aden International Airport for the second time.

UNVERIFIED **Gulf Business: several airlines extend Saudi suspensions into next week as Riyadh's closure deadline nears**

Gulf Business · **Sat AM** · Article dated Sat 17 Oct, exact publish time not shown; checked 8:58 AM

Gulf Business says cancellations continue across Saudi Arabia on Saturday and that several airlines have extended suspensions beyond 17 October. It notes the NOTAM deadline of 12:00 AM Sunday Riyadh time is not a confirmed reopening, and cites the coalition's figure of 20 attacks on King Khalid airport this month, with 17 killed and 333 injured.

CONFIRMED **Coalition says it destroyed two Houthi ballistic missile launch platforms in Saada**

SPA / Coalition spokesman Turki Al-Maliki · **4:35 AM** · Statement by Brig. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki on X, carried by SPA (spa.gov.sa N2703398) and Sabq at 4:35 AM AST Sat 17 Oct; checked 7:58 AM

The Saudi-led coalition's spokesman, Brig. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki, announced that two ballistic missile launch platforms were destroyed in Yemen's Saada province. He earlier released video of coalition strikes on Houthi weapons-smuggling by sea to Hodeidah. No further operational details were given.

4

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (8180 min).

25
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
9 departures + 16 arrivals, 20% of 126 scheduled.

—
LAST TAKEOFF
None on the board.

—
LAST LANDING
None on the board.

0
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

0
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 1:49 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 22 at 1:49 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	9	16	25	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	9 (16%)	13 (19%)	22	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	0 (0%)	0 (0%)	0	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (100%)	11 (100%)	15	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	0 of 32	0 of 43	0 of 75	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	139	124	263	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	98	87	185	FR24 stats panel

CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	6
Royal Jordanian	6
airblue	3
Badr Airlines	2
Riyadh Air	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Amman	4
Islamabad	2
Lahore	2
Port Sudan	2
Aqaba	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH

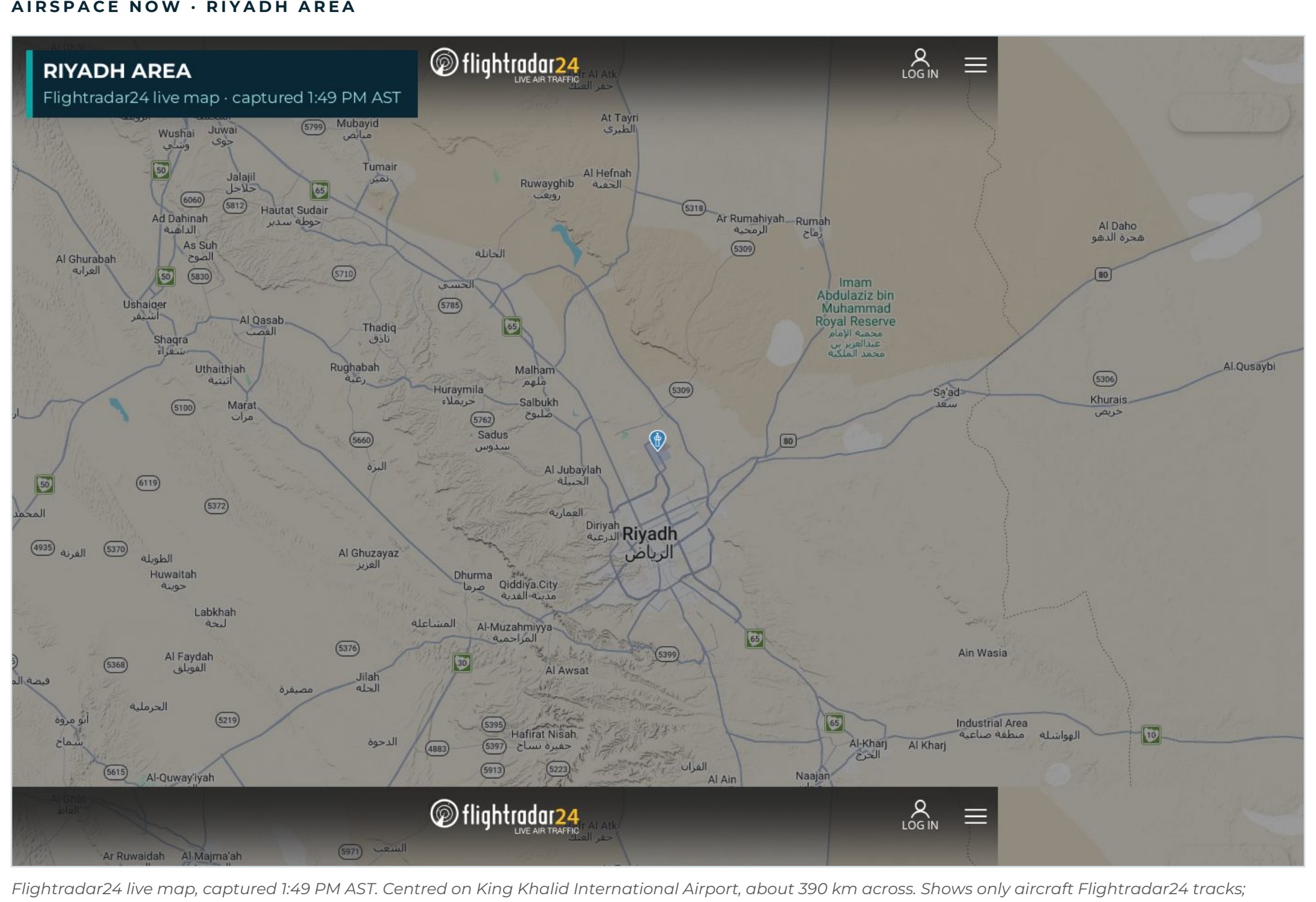
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 2:00 PM Friday to 1:49 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window, with no Riyadh movement in it. Dammam's halts in the window ran 4:10–5:13 PM and 5:44–7:14 PM Friday, then 11:32 PM–12:18 AM, 12:27–1:40 AM, 1:50–2:41 AM, 3:06–4:21 AM, 4:31–5:27 AM and 5:27–7:17 AM; Dammam has been moving since Saudia SV118 landed from London at 7:17 AM, with no halt open; its latest movement was Air Arabia 4P3 to Jeddah at 1:33 PM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	8180 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 1:49 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

5

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

22
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
10 departures + 12 arrivals, 11% of 192 scheduled.

1:33 PM
LAST TAKEOFF
4P3 to Jeddah, 15 min before 1:49 PM.

1:11 PM
LAST LANDING
SV1114 from Jeddah, 37 min before 1:49 PM.

1
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
1 landings in the last hour.

0
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
None recorded today.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 1:49 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 22 at 1:49 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	10	12	22	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	10 (10%)	12 (12%)	22	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	13 (14%)	13 (13%)	26	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	11 (46%)	12 (48%)	23	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	28 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	26 of 47	26 of 45	52 of 92	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	18	18	36	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	31	37	68	FR24 stats panel

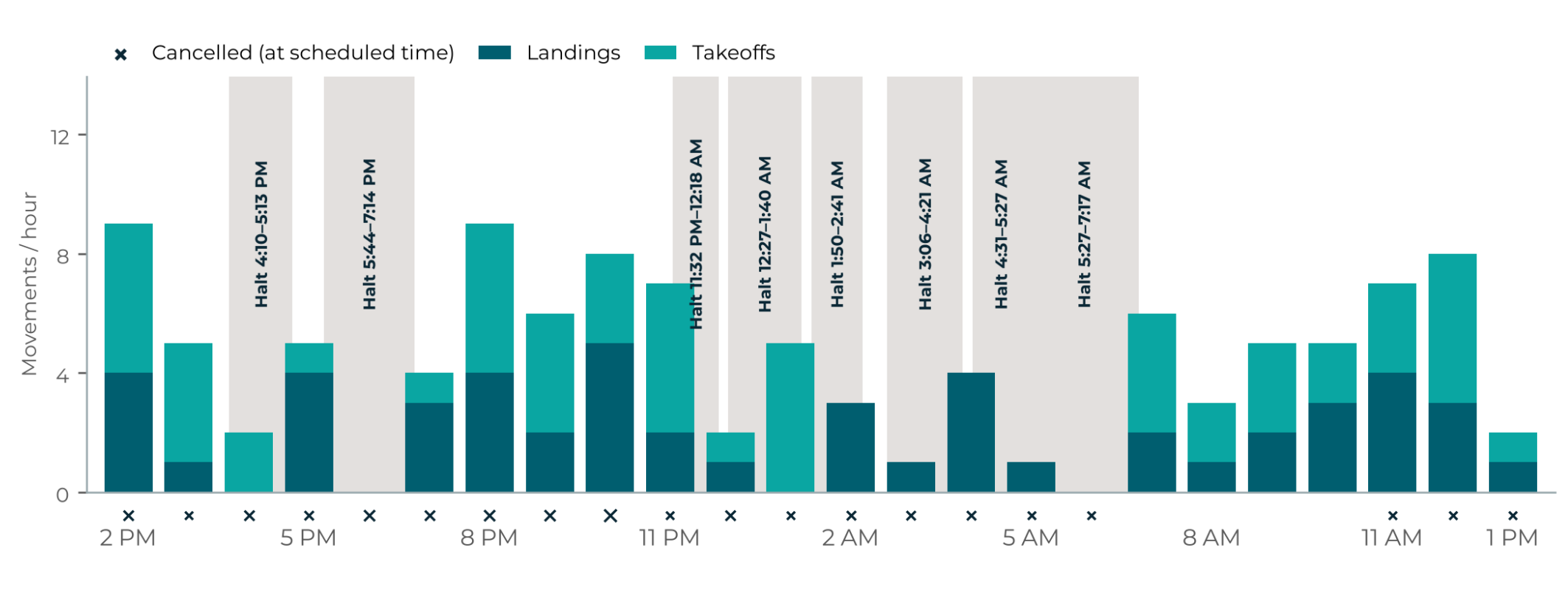
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Egyptair	8
flyadeal	4
Saudia	4
Turkish Airlines	2
Royal Jordanian	2

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	8
Cairo	6
Istanbul	2
Amman	2
Alexandria	2

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (56) and landings (51) at DMM per hour from 2:00 PM Friday to 1:49 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

No halt open; last halt 5:27 to 7:17 AM (109 min). 1 takeoff and 1 landing in the last hour.

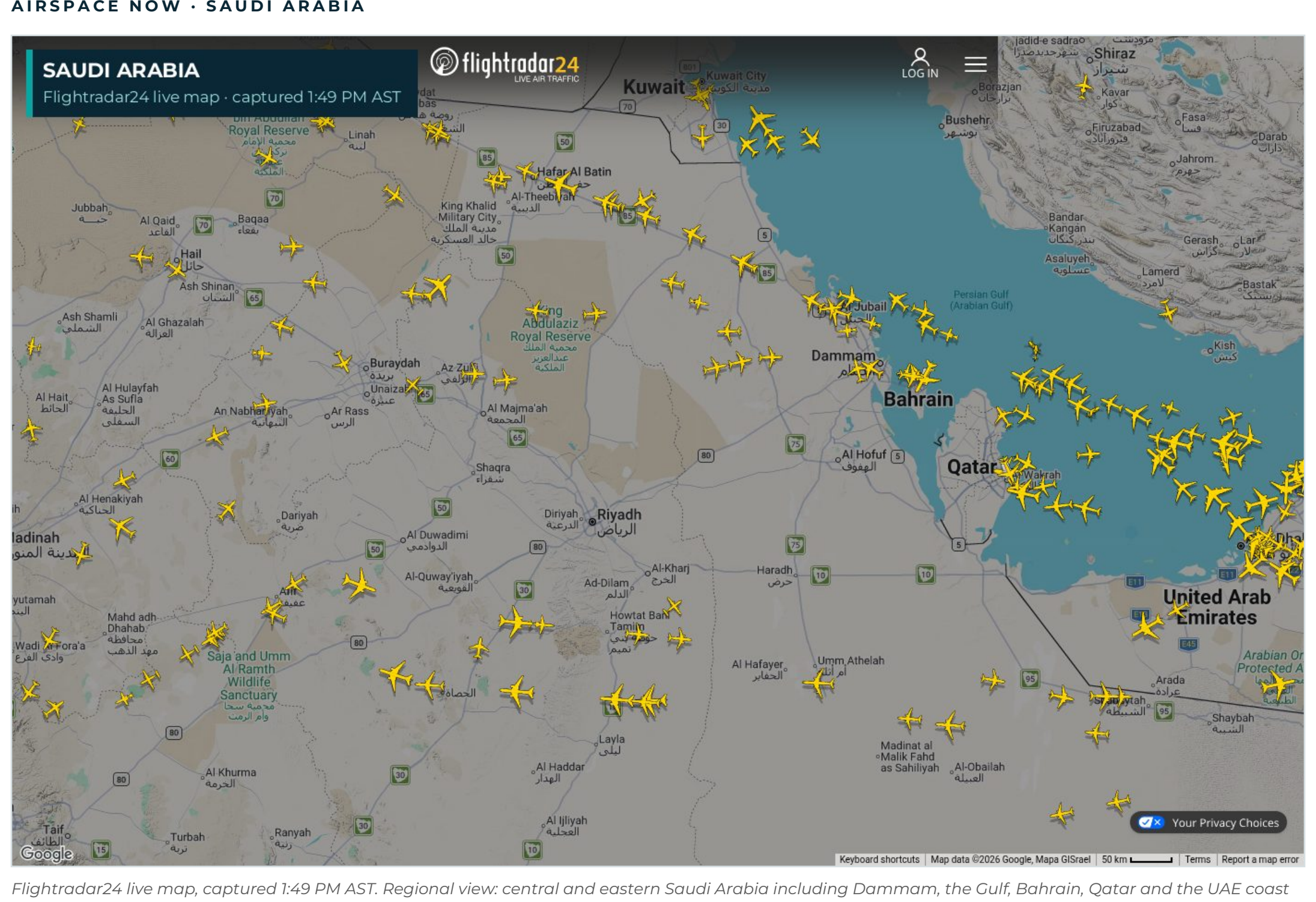
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 5:27–7:17 AM	109 min
Halt 4:31–5:27 AM	56 min
Halt 3:06–4:21 AM	76 min
Halt 1:50–2:41 AM	51 min
Halt 12:27–1:40 AM	73 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

UNVERIFIED **Social accounts report explosions heard around Dammam and fires at Eastern Province oil facilities overnight** (X (@TomthunkitsMind, @AlhryaWaltaghyr, @osinthexagone) · 7:33 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 1:49 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

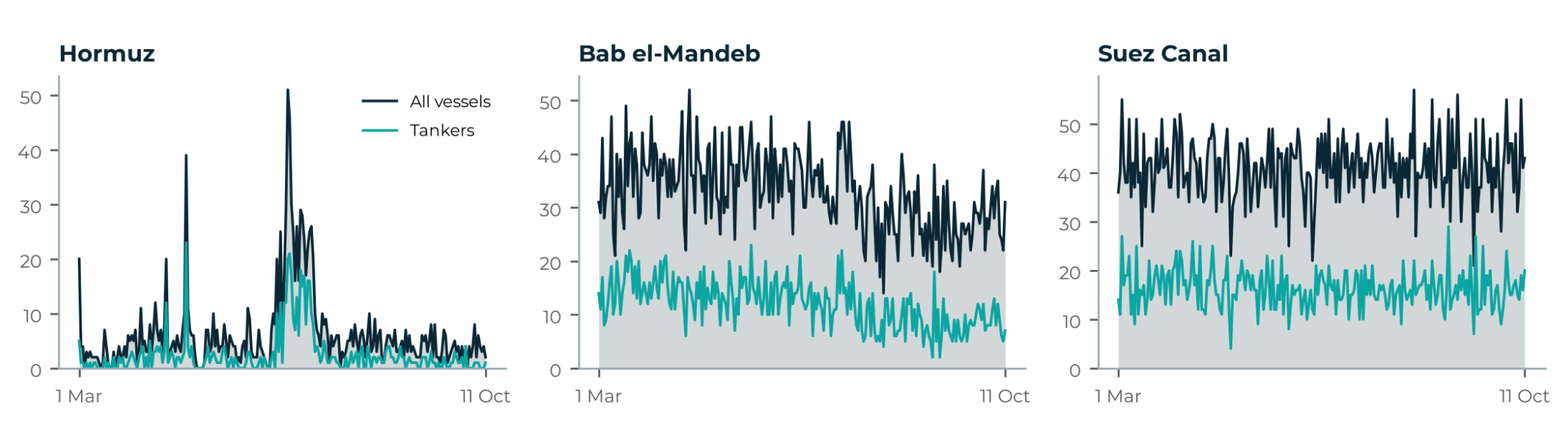
6

ECONOMY

Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

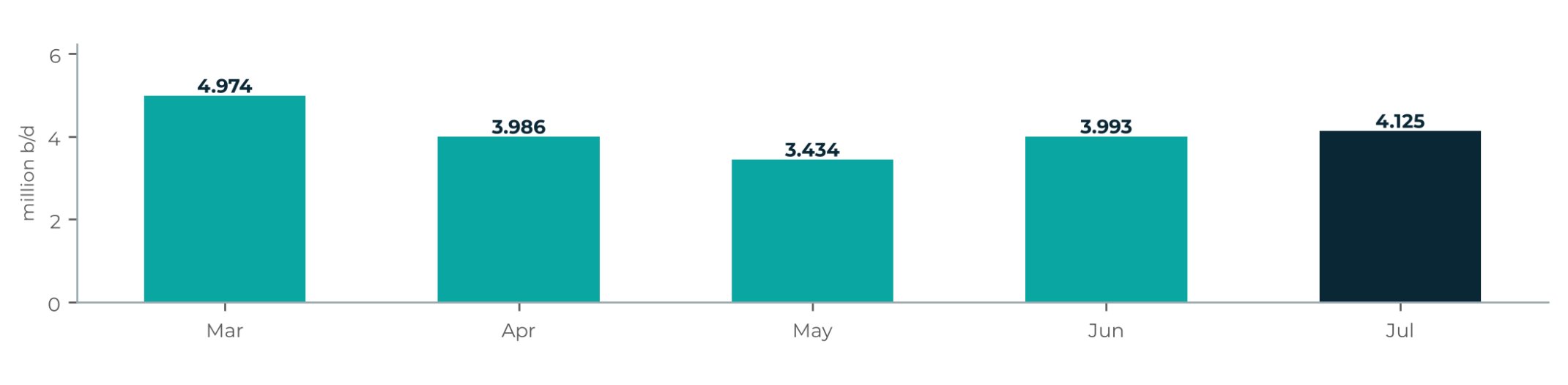
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 1:50 PM, Sat 17 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)



Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

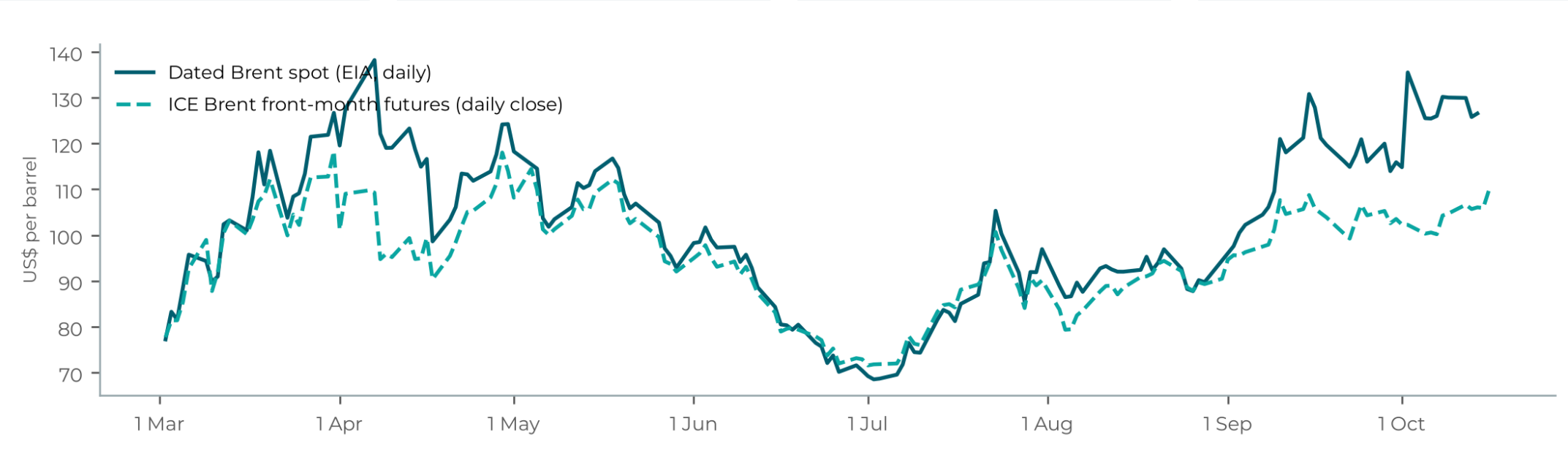
BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$109.86
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST
ICE front-month, 11:59 PM, Fri 16 Oct AST (+3.7% on day). Near real time.

$126.55
DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)
Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.

+4%
SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE
From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.

+64%
SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

7

METHOD AND LIMITS

What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 1:49 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
1:49 PM, Sat 17 Oct	1:49 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	3:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 PM